

Permission Types

There are three fundamental permission kinds for any file or directory:

- **Read:** A user's ability to read the contents of a file is all about the Read permission.
- **Write:** The write permission enables the user's ability to write or change a file or directory.
- **Execute:** A user's ability to run a file or examine the contents of a directory is affected by the Execute permission.

Users Permissions

Computers used to be huge devices that were prohibitively expensive. To get the most out of them, numerous computer terminals were connected, allowing multiple people to do business simultaneously. The machine did all of the data processing and storage, leaving the terminals to do nothing more than display and input data. Consider Dropbox, Gmail, and Amazon's Cloud MP3 system—while modifications can be performed locally, everything gets saved remotely.



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